

12-10-2024 MCS Board Meeting

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=t37GBw32tN8
Publication Date	2024-12-11T11:04:12Z
Target Category	mcs

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Municipal Meeting Summary Report

1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

No statutory public hearings or committee work sessions were held prior to the call to order.

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The meeting was called to order by the presiding officer [00:04:00](#), opening with a moment of silence and the Pledge of Allegiance led by student representatives [00:04:18](#).
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Mr. Heeter, Mr. Barnes, [Mr.] Griffin, Mr. Irvin, Mr. Low, [Ms.] Washburn.
 - **Members Absent:** Mr. Williams.
 - **Presiding Officer:** Dr. Reynolds (Superintendent / presiding leadership).

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** A moment of silence was observed, followed by the Pledge of Allegiance led by local students [00:04:18](#). The board also received student presentations

from North View Elementary regarding a social studies unit on Egypt [00:06:09](#).

- **Approval of Minutes:** *(Not explicitly detailed in the transcript text beyond standard procedural progression).*

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:41:48 Financial Report (November Financials & Rainy Day Fund)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. DeRome (Chief Financial Officer / Financial Staff).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Mr. DeRome presented the November financial report, noting the receipt of the state basic grant (\$3.8 million for the month, projecting slightly over \$47 million for the year based on an ADM count of 4,985 students). Early property tax draws of over \$3.6 million were received in November. Total cash balance stood at \$37.8 million, spiked by general obligation bond proceeds received in November 2024 for ongoing projects at Muncie Central Campus (Fieldhouse, parking lot, South concession/restroom, and electrical service). The outstanding state loan sits just over \$8 million, paid down at \$18,000 monthly. Excess funds at year-end will be targeted for transfer into the rainy day fund, primarily drawn from the education fund while maintaining a surplus.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote [00:46:27](#).
- **00:46:35 2025 Property and Casualty Insurance Renewal**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Brad DeRome / Administration.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Presented the annual Property and Casualty insurance renewal for 2025 through current agent USI and current carrier, noting a roughly \$112,000 premium increase over the previous year. Cyber and workers' comp renewals will be brought separately in January ahead of their February 1st due date. Despite exploring a 170-school Educational Service Center co-op option (which came back higher at roughly \$1 million), staff recommended proceeding with the USI renewal to ensure coverage effective January 1.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote [00:49:46](#).
- **00:49:54 Policy Review and Revisions**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Administration / reviewed with Church, Church, Hittle + Antrim.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Presented three policy updates:
 1. **Policy C-175 (Truancy Prevention):** Updated to reflect new Indiana statutory requirements regarding truancy prevention, parent notices, attendance conferences, and prosecutor referral guidelines for grades K<U+2013>6.

- 2. **Policy C-125 (Legal Settlements):** Adjusted due to House Bill 1315, moving certain statutory requirements from board guidelines into administrative guidelines.
 - 3. **Use of Metal Detectors:** Updated language from a 2018 policy to reflect current best practices, replacing “wands” with “metal detection devices” and updating administrative titles (e.g., Superintendent to Director of Public Education and CEO).
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote [00:54:06](#).
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- No members of the public signed up or spoke during the open public comment period ([00:41:19](#): “do we have any public comments? no public”).
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6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - Dr. Reynolds highlighted the 88th annual Community Sing event, student artwork selected for community holiday cards (by Abby Morton), and student attendance at the Caitlyn Clark / David Letterman event at Ball State.
 - Noted upcoming winter athletic and academic events, including the “City of Champions” basketball event at the Fieldhouse, and recent successes by Southside Middle School’s robotics D-team winning the Excellence Award.
 - Addressed morning weather/fog delay protocols and communication procedures.
 - Board members expressed holiday wishes ahead of the winter break and recognized local community efforts, such as Maxwell’s barbershop / Panther Pantry backpack drive supporting Southside students.
 - **Adjournment:** The meeting was adjourned by voice vote following a motion ([00:54:46](#) / [00:55:46](#)).
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